AUSTRALASIAN RECORD

"Sound an alarm: for the day of the Lord cometh, for it is nigh at hand."

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Marah and Elim

To-day 'tis Elim with its palms and wells,
And happy shade for desert weariness;
'Twas Marah yesterday, all rock and sand,
Unshaded solitude and dreariness.
Yet the same desert holds them both,
The same hot breezes wander o'er the lonely ground,
The same low stretch of valley shelters both,
And the same mountains compass them around.

So it is here with us on earth, and so
I do remember, it has ever been,
The bitter and the sweet, the grief and joy,
Lie near together, but a day between.
Sometimes God turns our bitter into sweet,
Sometimes He gives us pleasant water-springs,
Sometimes He shades us with His pillar-cloud,
And sometimes to a blessed palm-shade brings.

What matter it? The time will not be long,
Marah and Elim will alike be passed.
Our desert wells and palms will soon be done,
We reach the "City of our God" at last,
O happy land! Beyond these lonely hills,
Where gush in joy the everlasting springs.
O holy paradise! above these heavens,
Where we shall end our desert wanderings.

—*Selected.*

Holiday Presents—No. 1

THE holidays are approaching. In view of this fact, it will be well to consider how much money is expended yearly in making presents to those who have no need of them. The habits of custom are so strong that to withhold gifts from our friends on these occasions would seem to us almost a neglect of them. But let us remember that our kind heavenly Benefactor has claims upon us far superior to those of any earthly friend. Shall we not, during the coming holidays, present our offerings to God? Even the children may participate in this work. Clothing and other useful articles may be given to the worthy poor, and thus a work may be done for the Master.

Let us remember that Christmas is supposed to be celebrated in commemoration of the birth of the world's Redeemer. This day is generally spent in feasting and gluttony. Large sums of money are spent in needless self-indulgence. The appetite and selfish pleasures are indulged at the expense of the physical, mental, and moral power. This has become a habit. Pride, fashion, and gratification of the palate have swallowed up immense sums of money that have really benefited no one, but have encouraged a prodigality of means that is displeasing to God. These days are spent in glorifying self rather than God. Health has been sacrificed, money worse than thrown away; many have lost their lives through over-eating, or through demoralizing dissipation, and souls have been lost through this means.

God would be glorified by His children should they enjoy a plain, simple diet, and use the means entrusted to them in bringing to His treasury offerings, small and great, to be used in sending the light of truth to souls that are in the darkness of error. The hearts of the widow and the fatherless may be made to rejoice because of the gifts which will add to their comfort and satisfy their hunger.

Let all who profess to believe the present truth calculate how much they spend yearly, and especially upon the recurrence of the annual holidays, for the gratification of selfish and unholy desires, how much in the indulgence of appetite, and how much to compete with others in un-Christian display. Sum up the means thus spent all needlessly, and then estimate how much might be saved as consecrated gifts to God's cause without injury to soul or body. Mites and more liberal gifts may be brought in, according to the ability of the giver, to aid in lifting debts from churches which have been dedicated to God. Then there are missionaries to be sent into new fields, and others to be supported in their respective fields of labour. These missionaries have to practise the strictest economy, even denying themselves the very things many enjoy daily, and which you consider the necessaries of life. They enjoy few luxuries.

If after prayerful consideration of this matter you are not moved to prompt and zealous action, we shall know that you have forgotten your first love, that you have lost sight of the sacrifices Jesus has made for you that you might be blessed with the gift of eternal life. Said Christ, "If any man will come after Me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow Me." Self-denial is a work of Christianity. To offer to God gifts that have cost something,

a sacrifice that we shall ask Him to use to advance His cause in the earth, will be pleasing to Him. The Saviour will accept the free will offerings of every one, from the oldest to the youngest. Even small children may participate in this work and enjoy the privilege of bringing their little offerings. While we have been mindful of our earthly friends from year to year, have we not neglected our heavenly Friend? In bestowing our gifts liberally upon our friends, have we not forgotten God, and passed Him by?

Will a man rob God? Yet ye have robbed Me. But ye say, Wherein have we robbed Thee? In tithes and offerings. Ye are cursed with a curse: for ye have robbed Me, even this whole nation. Bring ye all the tithes into the storehouse, that there may be meat in Mine house, and prove Me now herewith, saith the Lord of hosts, if I will not open you the windows of heaven, and pour you out a blessing, that there shall not be room enough to receive it.

Heavy debts are upon several of our churches. Let us consider from this time how we may economise in expending our means, and help to remove these encumbrances. As Christians, we should follow the directions of the inspired apostle:

Whose adorning let it not be that outward adorning of plaiting the hair, and of wearing of gold, or of putting on of apparel; but let it be the hidden man of the heart, in that which is not corruptible, even the ornament of a meek and quiet spirit, which is in the sight of God of great price. For after this manner in the old time the holy women also, who trusted in God, adorned themselves.

The apostle Paul gave directions to Timothy similar to the instructions given by Peter:

I will therefore that men pray everywhere, lifting up holy hands, without wrath and doubting. In like manner also, that women adorn themselves in modest apparel, with shamefacedness and sobriety; not with broidered hair, or gold, or pearls, or costly array; but (which becometh women professing godliness) with good works.

It would be well-pleasing to God if extra ornaments, so explicitly forbidden among the people of God, were laid off. Now is a favourable opportunity to present them to God. They may be sold for something, and the money thus received may be used to advance the precious cause of truth. Let the wearing of useless trimmings and adornings be discarded. Extravagance should never be indulged to gratify our pride. Our dress may be of good quality, made up with plainness and simplicity, for durability rather than display. Our appetites must also be brought into subjection, and not gratified to our injury. The question should come home to every heart, "How much owest thou unto my Lord?" God has granted us privileges and blessings without number; we are dependent upon Him for every earthly favour; and now should not the bands of selfishness be broken and removed from us, and the just claims of God and humanity be met?

Missionaries are planting the standard of truth in foreign lands. Publications must be multiplied, and scattered like the leaves of autumn. These silent messengers are enlightening and moulding the minds of thousands in every country and in every clime. As a people, we come far short of moving forward as fast as the providence of God opens the way. He has given us the command, "Go forward." Thousands are thirsting for living truth. The Macedonian cry is coming to us from every direction, "Come over and help us." We look about us and enquire, "Who will go?" One and another may respond, "Here am I, Lord, send me. I long to do something for my Master." But to do this requires money.

Time and again I have had presented before me a vision of people, across the broad ocean, standing in perplexity, and pale with anxiety, and earnestly enquiring, "What is truth?" Say they, "We want the bread of life."

Our churches are backslidden from God. They have become proud, selfish, and worldly. We want to find the old paths. We want to come back to the simplicity of gospel religion.

Our tears will flow as we see this picture, like a reality, rising vividly before us. The voice from heaven pleads, "Go ye therefore into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature." While so great a work remains to be done, shall not we, as Christ's followers, rouse to a sense of our God-given responsibilities, and be active in doing our part?

MRS. E. G. WHITE.

"IGNORANCE of the best methods of teaching is no excuse for second-rate work; for no one who is willing to learn need be ignorant."

In Sunny California

HERE at San Fernando Academy, we have been enjoying the privilege for a few weeks of learning much about China, and the way the work is carried on in that vast field. Pastor S. Nagel and wife are in America on a furlough, after six years spent in the southern part of the Celestial Empire, and they came to San Fernando for a short time, as Mrs. Nagel's people live here.

The class in the Academy that is studying the History of Missions was fortunate enough to secure Pastor Nagel as teacher while he was here, and he made the study of China a very inspiring one.

A good spiritual work was done for the young people of the Academy and for the church by the many studies which he gave on the great need of the Holy Spirit in missions—home or foreign. Last Wednesday evening, just before Pastor and Mrs. Nagel left to attend the important council meeting at Loma Linda, a beautiful baptismal service was conducted in the Fernando church. Thirteen young people, one of whom was our son Albert, followed their lowly Master in this path of self-denial.

There are several of the regular teachers on the Academy staff who have spent some time in foreign work. These help to create a missionary atmosphere in the school.

The Academy closed for a day recently and sent its young folk out by train and motor to the towns in this vicinity to scatter the Harvest Ingathering *Signs* and to collect money for missions. Upwards of twenty-five pounds was brought home.

There are about one hundred and twenty-five students enrolled, eighty of whom live in the Academy homes, the rest living near by with parents or relatives. And they are certainly highly privileged young people who attend, though the thoughtlessness and light-heartedness of youth sometimes causes them to forget it.

The San Fernando Academy is affiliated with Pacific Union College and Lodi Academy, and keeps well

up to the educational standard set for our schools. There are exceptionally good advantages to be had here in music. It has been in existence for thirteen years, though the big red brick college building has stood many years longer than that, as it was built for, and used by, the University of Southern California before the Adventists bought it.

The situation is lovely. At the back rise the rough hills that shut in the rich and prosperous San Fernando valley. The hills are bare and tawny now, at the end of the dry season. It has been all sunshine since we have been here, and the hills make a picture that seems almost unreal, so cameo-clear do they rise against an opalescent sky. Endless orchards of oranges, olives, walnuts, and peaches, fill the valley, and ranches that grow innumerable other fruits and vegetables. This valley has the distinction of having the largest olive orchard in the world.

My boys and I have profited much by the change of scene and climate which we have enjoyed since we left Avondale and settled in southern California. At first America seemed like a strange land, but we met at the different places we went many old friends from Australia, and later have formed pleasant acquaintances, and we find that the Lord's people and His work are the same in all lands. The European war does not fill so large a place on the horizon in America as it does in Australia, but those who are waiting for the Son of man to come in His kingdom watch closely the passing events, and see in the rapid development of events, the unfailing signs that that kingdom "hasteth greatly."

MRS. B. S. CHANEY.

Another Farewell at the College

ALTHOUGH scarcely three weeks had elapsed since we had expressed our appreciation of the life amongst us of one of our number, and accorded him an appropriate farewell, we again assembled on Monday evening, November 29, to show two more departing friends the esteem and regard with which they are held.

This time, however, it was not only old students who were leaving; it was not only members of the faculty departing; but it combined both. Both of those to whom the meeting was accorded were former students, and both have, during the past year, been members of the faculty, but our farewell was given to them in their capacity of principal and wife.

As doubtless all RECORD readers know, Brother and Sister Mills have resigned their responsible relationship with the college in order that they might pursue further studies, and thus more fully equip themselves for greater efficiency in the Lord's work. But from this it must not be inferred that their efforts here have been of no avail. All will admit that in many ways the past school year has been one stamped with the hall-mark of success, and this has been due in no mean degree to the untiring energies and never-flagging zeal of the "man at the helm." Storms and shoals have been encountered, but with the principles of truth as a compass, and the Word of God as a beacon light, all has gone well. It was with thoughts such as these that a large number of students, department superintendents, and faculty members gathered together to provide a surprise for those so soon to leave us.

The evening, which was of a social character, consisted of a varied programme, comprising selections rendered by the students, and at its close, Brother W. Scragg, in making the presentation of a writing desk to the principal, expressed the very best thanks and wishes of all the members of the institution. In replying, Brother Mills thanked those present for their practical expression of gratitude, and stated how grateful he was to the faculty and superintendents, not forgetting the students themselves, for their co-operation and help.

A purse and album were then presented to Sister Mills at the hand of Miss D. Thorpe, who, more particularly on behalf of the young ladies, wished her to accept them as a mark of the esteem with which she is held. The purse was a gift from the whole institution, but the autograph album was subscribed for by the young ladies who had been working under the able supervision of Mrs. Mills during this vacation, and by this, showing their gratitude for help and encouragement received. Mrs. Mills fittingly responded.

The remarks made by the students' representatives were endorsed and extended by the chairman, Brother R. Burns, and the continued blessing of God was asked for by Brother Chaney. We all feel assured that these departing workers will still be led by the Almighty, and that His hand will be seen indicating the path in which they are to tread.

A most pleasant evening was thus spent; another step in heaven's flight has been ascended; and we all look forward to another year of study, service, and satisfactory results.

AN AVONDALE STUDENT.

Good Intentions

I thought to do a kindly deed;
Time slipped away too fast.
The deed is still undone, ah, me!
My chance for ever past.

I meant to speak a cheering word.
Before that word was said
The idle world walked by, and now
The friend I loved is dead.

—*Alice Van Leer Carrick.*

Work Where We Are

IT is very common to hear people say: "If I were in different circumstances, I could do so much more for the cause. If I could only go here or go there—if only this obstacle or that were removed, I might do something." The fact is, we can do *what we can*, wherever we are, and we should do no more than that anywhere. The missionary spirit shows itself as truly in the home as in a foreign land, and whoever can find nothing to do where he is, would make sorry work in a broader field. "It is not *where* we are, but *what* we are" that the angels record. If we think that a change of circumstances would improve our spiritual condition, let us consider whether a change of *heart* is not needed more. A good text for us to think of sometimes may be found in Jer. 2:36.—*Minnesota Worker.*

"IF you have a good thought be not content until that thought is converted into a noble action."

YOU can not dream yourself into a character; you must hammer and forge yourself into one.—*Froude.*

"WHEN one becomes too good for the church, and too wise for sermons, he invariably is the first to discover it."

Mission Hymn

God of the Universe!
Who knowest all the curse
That sin has wrought,
May light come from Thy throne,
And power from Thee alone,
To break the hearts of stone
Thy love has bought!

Look, Lord, with pitying eye
On those who're doomed to die
In heathen lands.
Send us to point the way,
Turn them from gods of clay
To Him,—the Light, the Way.
Love, break their bands!

Let not our love of ease
Seek only self to please,
But seek the lost.
May others' needs be ours
To help with all our powers,
Ere the last storm-cloud lowers;
Not count the cost!

—*Selected.*

Samoa

IT may be interesting to the readers of the RECORD to know a little more of the progress of the work in this field.

I am writing this on the eve of my leaving for New Zealand on a short furlough.

We have spent almost six years in this field and have been trying to scatter the seeds of truth by the printed page and by word of mouth. Truly God has fulfilled His word to us in Eccl. 11:6: "In the morning sow thy seed, and in the evening withhold not thine hand: for thou knowest not whether shall prosper, either this or that, or whether they both shall be alike good."

Before Mrs. Howse left she was permitted to see our first baptism of five Samoans, and also to see our first church building erected in Samoa. This was a very happy time to us all, and our hearts were full as these natives were led down into the watery grave. They are rejoicing in the truth and it is doing for them what it will do for all, whether black or white.

In Brother Steed's latest report he stated that we had received a call from a chief to visit him at his home, a few miles farther down the coast past our mission property, and hold studies. This man is a brother of one of the women who were baptized.

I have been acquainted with this man for some time and had given him papers and Bible talks. When he heard that his sister had accepted the truth he wanted to hear more about it. We visited him in his home, and I held studies with him and instructed him in the truth, and now he and his wife are baptized.

This man was a very high chief, and this means much to him according to Samoan custom, as there are many old heathen forms and customs connected with chieftainship.

The title of a chief is handed down from father to son. It consists in a name, the honour, rule, a long staff, and a switch made from long horse hair with a short handle, the different styles being a sign of the rank of chieftainship.

When a company of chiefs or others from another place visits a village, the chief has to entertain them with food, pigs always being in the bill of fare, *kava* (native drink), and dancing which is licentious in character.

Another custom is that when any one dies, especially a chief, they make a great feast and spend days in exchanging fine mats and pigs. This entertainment is always accompanied with much feasting, where the pig plays a very important part.

When we first visited this man, Brother Steed and I took a walk to the back of his house and the first thing we saw was a patch of tobacco growing; next was a large patch of *kava*, and then a high wall, and behind this wall the man's pigs. This animal is very valuable to the Samoan.

These things have all had a clean sweep, which shows the power the truth has upon the human heart. Here is a man living in surroundings so contrary to the truth, and yet the Word of God can change that man's heart till he can hate the things he once loved, and love the things he once hated.

We find this precious truth will do the same for these dark people that it does for those living under more favourable conditions.

We baptized three others with this man and his wife. One of these is a bright young man who heard the truth from me about three years ago. He then told me he could not obey because he had received an appointment from the government. He has again studied the truth and is obeying it this time.

He is working in the hospital now, but hopes to become a worker for the truth of God. He is well educated, having spent years in studying and teaching at the London Mission School in Samoa.

The work is onward in Samoa, and I am sure you all rejoice with us. Remember us continually with your prayers, your offerings, and your young people, as this field, like all others, needs more workers. Remember there is a language to learn which means that recruits must come soon to be able to do effective work before the message closes. As I leave Samoa, I leave with good courage and with hopes of soon returning renewed in vigour and energy, to again labour for the salvation of these needy people.

T. HOWSE.

Solomon Islands

IN a private letter written from the Marovo Lagoon, Solomon Islands, Brother Nicholson writes encouragingly of the progress of the work. He says: "We like the islands and the people, and are enjoying our work. When one glances over the field, it seems wonderful what has been accomplished here. The Lord has certainly blessed the work, and we feel confident that He will not permit the enemy to mar its future. While it is true that they have many strange customs, there is much that is to be admired in these people, and there is much that is good. They are very moral, and marriage is considered sacred. They are also honest. Although there are things all around the mission that could easily be taken, we have never missed an article. The natives are given rice while they are working, but they never take it unless it is given. One day we left some biscuits in the boat for them, but forgot to mention it, and although they slept there, not one was touched. They went without their breakfast. Recently a native stayed behind from a feast to mind our misson in our absence. This was done unknown to us at the time, and he gave as his reason that

he feared that some thief might come and take some of our property. Thus you see they have many promising traits of character."

Literature for Soldiers

THE following has been received from the secretary of the South New Zealand Tract Society, showing what is being done in that field to give the third angel's message to the soldiers who are leaving for the front. Could not a similar work be done equally well in other conferences?

"The whole land is stirred with a spirit of patriotism, and brave boys from homes all around us are answering the call for more volunteers. They come from all stations in life, some rich, some poor, some religious, and some otherwise. As we hear of them embarking for the front, do we not constantly remember that they are forging some of the very last links in the chain of prophetic events that lead to the coming of the Prince of Peace? and to Him shall be given 'dominion, and glory, and a kingdom, that all people, nations, and languages, should serve Him: His dominion is an everlasting dominion, which shall not pass away, and His kingdom that which shall not be destroyed.'

"The blessed hope of soon meeting our Saviour and inheriting the kingdom sustains us while passing through these trying times. But how about the 'boys' who are taking so active a part in the fulfilment of prophecy? Do they understand these things? We have read of how the terrors of war have led many of the soldiers who were formerly indifferent to religion, to read their Bibles and seek refuge and protection under the wings of the Almighty. Would not this be an opportune time to place in their hands literature containing present truth? Such thoughts as these led us to adopt the plan which is being worked in the North Island of New Zealand with success.

"Collecting cards have been printed, which we are handing to our church members, asking them to solicit donations from their friends and neighbours for the purchasing of Scriptural literature for free distribution among the troops as they embark. We have in mind such books as "Armageddon," "World's Crisis," "Steps to Christ," etc., which will be supplied at the reduced rate of nine pence a copy.

"Furthermore, we have thought that our members would esteem it a privilege to each pledge the price of one book every two months towards the same fund. That means that every two months each of our members would make a gift of one book to the soldiers.

"Who knows but what these gifts may be the means in God's hands of saving some precious soul in the everlasting kingdom where there will be no more war!"

A Colporteur's Experiences in North Queensland—No. 1

WHEN canvassing in Mackay I called at the home of a blind woman. She was in poor circumstances, and could not order the book. I asked if she would like me to read the Bible to her. She was pleased to listen and also to have prayer. I took my wife to visit her, and she with Sister Anderson continued her visits until this lady was baptized. Some months later she was taken to the hospital, and died, believing in the third angel's message.

Another experience was with a man who, after Bible studies, also began keeping the Sabbath. Then again, I met two young men, brothers, one of whom ordered the book, "Patriarchs and Prophets." I had a good talk with him. When I delivered the book, I stayed one night with these brothers, and talked with them about the Sabbath truth. A week later one of them came to our home on Sabbath morning, and said he wanted to see me on business. I waited to see what his business was, and he said, "My brother and I have found that we are keeping the wrong Sabbath." We invited him to come to Sabbath-school with us, and we had a good time together. We gave them some tracts and *Signs*, also the book, "Honour Due to God." They came again to ask us how to pay tithe. I was away at the time, so afterwards arranged that I should spend the next week-end with them. They lived twenty-two miles from us, and I was canvassing twenty miles beyond them. As this visit would mean a day lost from my work, we asked the Lord to make it up to me that week. With the blessing of the Lord I secured thirty-one orders in four days and sold twenty helps. By this means I was enabled to pay the promised visit to the home of these brethren, and before I left they paid their first tithe, which amounted to £79 1s. 9d. As it happened to be the week of prayer, they made the amount up to £85 with their week of prayer offering.

I called on another man and took his order. He asked if I was a Seventh-day Adventist, and I told him I was. He then invited me to dinner. Shortly after I delivered his book, I received a letter from him asking for an explanation of the mark of the beast. My wife sent him some *Signs* and the tract, "The Seal of God and the Mark of the Beast," and wrote him a letter. He came to see us at the time Pastor Butz was here, so we explained the truth more fully to him and he decided to obey God. He asked Pastor Butz and me to come to his home, as he did not want his wife to keep Sabbath just because he did, but because of God's Word. We went about twenty-two miles by train and bicycle, and spent a profitable time with them. Now they are both rejoicing in the truth.

Sister Anderson took me to see a lady who was a member of the Salvation Army, and whose daughter is at our college. This woman also is now obeying God's commandments.

When the state agent wrote and asked if I knew a Mrs. ——, I said, "No, but if she is interested in the truth I will find her." I did find her. She is living ten miles from Mackay. She said, "This is a wicked place in which to live. When we were in England, a few months ago, we could go to chapel twice on Sundays, but here they never go." When her husband came home to dinner she told him that they were keeping the wrong day for the Sabbath and that Jesus was soon coming. He said if he had known that before, he would never have come out to Queensland; but she replied that he might not then have heard this truth. This lady and her eldest daughter are now Sabbath-keepers, and we be-

lieve the husband will soon follow. These people are working for an Italian who, when he heard about the message, bought an Italian Bible, and is now studying it.

We next studied with a Mrs. ——. She attended our last camp-meeting, and is now well established in the truth. A. T. START.

The Tasmanian Conference

IT was my privilege to attend the Tasmanian Conference, which was held in the Hobart church, November 25 to 28. Pastor C. H. Watson was to have been present at this meeting, but was prevented by his delayed return from New Zealand.

The Hobart and Bismarck Churches were strongly represented at the conference. There were representatives from the Glen Huon Church, and a good number of isolated believers. Brother H. C. Harker was the only delegate present from the north of the island.

The holding of a camp-meeting has been dispensed with for this year. The conference is making a new start, and has but little equipment. Judging, however, by the spirit of unity among the believers, the earnestness and enthusiasm that characterised the meetings, and the evidences already to be seen of marked progress since the reorganization of the conference some six months ago, there is every reason to look next year for a larger and better camp-meeting than Tasmania has ever held. There was not one dissenting vote throughout the proceedings. The animated discussion of resolutions relating to the different departments of church work seemed full of promise of the resolutions being remembered and put into practice in the churches. I have never seen a "pledge" meeting where a better spirit was manifested than was seen on the Sunday afternoon when the offerings were made for the tent and equipment fund. The amount subscribed might not be regarded as large in some of our stronger conferences, but it was large considering the number present at the meeting, and lifted the amount available for equipment to a figure that makes sure of the full amount asked for being raised when the believers not present at the conference are given the opportunity to help.

The reports of the president and the labourers were of an encouraging nature. Six or seven had recently been added to the conference, double that number were awaiting baptism, and the workers had promising interests. The reorganization of this conference was affected with the hope that it would make possible a closer oversight of the churches and isolated believers, and the benefits in that direction seem to be already apparent.

In the election of the officers, the Executive Committee, and the departmental leaders, no changes were made. The president, Pastor A. H. White, has the confidence and co-operation of the believers.

The Lord has also blessed the cause in Tasmania financially. During the first six months the new conference received £773 19s. 8½d. in tithe. The amount received for the preceding twelve months was £913 10s. 10½d, so that for six months the receipts are less than those of the previous year by only £139 11s. 2d. This has left a good balance in the treasury for the development of aggressive work.

The Lord came very near to us in the Sabbath-morning meeting, and a goodly number were led to make a full surrender to Him. In the afternoon our foreign mission work was considered, followed by a review of the work before our young people's societies. In this meeting a large number decided to join in the Missionary Volunteer Reading Course for 1916.

The Sunday-evening meeting was held in the Masonic Hall, Murray Street, and was well attended. The speaking during the four days of the meeting was divided between Brethren A. H. White, H. C. Harker, and the writer. The delegates returned to their homes with renewed courage, confidently expecting God's blessing on His cause to be continued to the end. W. W. FLETCHER.

A Trip to the Country

SHORTLY after our camp-meeting at Parramatta, I spent a week in taking a much-needed rest at Katoomba in the Blue Mountains.

From there I went to Bathurst for a few days. For a number of months Sister Robertson had been working in this town, with encouraging results. While there I had the privilege of baptizing five persons, one of them being a deaf and dumb woman who had been keeping the Sabbath, and who lived about twenty-two miles in the country, and who drove that distance that she might receive baptism. A crippled young man expected to be baptized, but was ill in bed when the time came.

The little church building, which was erected there a number of years ago when there was a church organization in the town, has received some renovation, and is now surrounded with a fence, which makes the premises look very neat. Later we hope to see the believers organised into a church.

Some of the students from our college were canvassing the town for *Life and Health*, with good results. One of our book colporteurs is located here as resident colporteur, and is having fair success. The work of the Lord looks encouraging in this city.

From Bathurst I went to Eugowra, accompanied part of the way by Brother McLaren, who has charge of the *Life and Health* colporteurs. Two young men whom we met at Blayney were doing well in selling these magazines. A few days were spent at Eugowra. In this part of the state there is a splendid wheat crop. The Eugowra brethren have hundreds of acres of fine wheat, which in a measure makes up for the hard times of the past few years. I was glad to find all the members of the company firm in the faith, and trying to give the message to others.

At Orange I again met Brother Meincke, who had just buried his aged wife. Now this feeble brother must walk life's pathway alone. Brother J. W. Roberts is doing a good work here with "Great Controversy," and a company of lady colporteurs are succeeding well with *Life and Health*.

On my return to Bathurst I found that Sister Robertson had just met with a severe accident through a fall received while going down a flight of stairs. While she will be compelled to stop work for a time, it is hoped the injury will not be serious. At this time we celebrated the Lord's

Supper, this being the first time some of the company had ever taken part in this ordinance. It was good to see the earnestness of the new believers. May the Lord prosper His work in this part of the state.

E. H. GATES.

From an Isolated Sabbath-Keeper in New South Wales

THE following is from a letter written to Miss E. M. James, the state secretary of the Sabbath-school department in New South Wales, and shows how one of the isolated members conducts her Sabbath-school. It is certainly a worthy example to follow:

"I received your very welcome letter with the home department envelope on the 11th inst., and was pleased for your kind remembrance of me.

"Yes, I am here alone where there is no Sabbath-school, and as I am well aware that the study of the lesson develops the mental, moral, and physical powers, I would rather do anything than drop it out on Sabbath. Therefore, I gladly enrol as a member of the home department. Before I received your letter, I indeed felt that I was isolated, although I was by no means discouraged; but now that isolated feeling has gone, for in my isolation I can remember that I am connected with other members of the home department, some of whom are, no doubt, in similar circumstances to myself. I can also remember that we are all bound together by the thread of the home department, which our Sabbath-school department has thrown around every isolated Sabbath-keeper.

"Regarding my plans of study, they are as follow: Through the week, my waking thoughts turn first to the morning watch. Then before I rise I look through the Sabbath-school lesson. This plan is followed out every morning, laying particular stress upon the questions which are set apart for the day.

"Then when Sabbath comes, I repair to the hills, which lie close on the north side, and, finding a secluded spot, ask God's blessing upon it, and commence Sabbath-school, following the same plan that they do in larger schools. I was somewhat hampered about the missionary exercise, but some one has kindly sent me a *Missionary Leader*, which I received early last week, and now I can share in this exercise also. I sing some of the splendid hymns from "Christ in Song," and have prayer. As it would be useless to write up the minutes of the previous Sabbath's meeting, since this Sabbath-school consists of one only, I spend a little time in reflecting upon the blessings of last Sabbath, and in counting up instances of God's mercy which I have experienced during the week. This is followed by a short review of the previous week's lesson, and the lesson for the day.

"As you will see by this, I have the current quarter's pamphlet, but I am enclosing a postal note for one shilling, which will serve to keep me supplied with pamphlets next year.

"I trust the Lord is greatly blessing the Sabbath-school work."

Obituaries

MASTERS.—In 1887, Captain George Masters, a veteran of the Indian Mutiny, became, under the labours of Pastor A. G. Daniells in New Zealand, a soldier of the cross; henceforth to fight "against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world." As a colporteur Brother Masters returned to India bearing the message of life and peace. Twenty-nine years have passed in faithful service since then, activity being moderated only by the advancing burden of years, until at the age of eighty-five the call of death came. On Sabbath, November 27, we laid the old soldier of Christ to rest in the Avondale Cemetery, at Cooranbong, New South Wales. Another call shall come, and he who lived so faithfully a life of obedience, shall answer to the trumpet-sound and come forth to take his place in the mighty army of the redeemed. Pastor C. H. Watson conducted the service at the grave, Brother Joseph Mills offering prayer. "Sweet Be Thy Rest" was sung at the close of the service, and with its sweetly solemn strains sounding in our ears we moved away and left the dead to await in peace the Life-giver.

J. D. K. AITKEN.

BATES.—On Sabbath, November 27, at the home of his parents, Eric Vivian, younger son of Brother and Sister Bates, of Edendale Church, Auckland, New Zealand, passed away at the early age of three years and two months. About nine months ago that dread disease, consumption, fastened its hold on the little fellow, and slowly but surely sapped the young life in spite of all efforts to check it. The past five months of his life were spent in the Auckland Hospital, from whence he was removed to his home a few days prior to his death. About eighteen months ago the third angel's message was accepted by his parents, and while not fully understanding the reason of their sad trial, yet they calmly submit, and now look forward with fond hope to the realization of the promise, "They shall not labour in vain, nor bring forth for trouble: for they are the seed of the blessed of the Lord, and their offspring with them." This lamb of the fold was laid to rest in the Papakura Cemetery, there to await the call of the Life-giver. Words of comfort were spoken at the home, also at the grave-side, by the writer.

G. G. STEWART.

MEINCKE.—Died at Orange, November 19, 1915, Sister Hannah Meincke, aged seventy-four years. For nine years this sister has been a great sufferer, and death, from heart disease, came practically instantaneously. Her husband, who is feeble, has had the care of her during these years. Sister Meincke was born in Cambridgeshire, England, and came to this country when ten years old. In 1881 she was married to Brother S. Meincke. By a former husband she had one son, who still lives. In early life she was connected with the Anglican Church. About thirteen years ago she became a Sabbath-keeper with her husband, at which time there was a church organization in Orange; but for several years she has had no church privileges. As none of our ministers were within reach, the funeral services were conducted by Rev. Mr. Taylor, of the Church of England. A few days later I was permitted to visit the home and spend an hour or two with Brother Meincke, who must now walk the pathway of life alone. Death is the last enemy, but the Life-giver will soon appear. May God grant His blessing to this aged brother.

E. H. GATES.

THOMSON.—Died at the home of her parents, "Tarrawatta," Church St., Willoughby, New South Wales, on Sunday, November 28, 1915, Worthie Hilda Minnie, the only child of Brother and Sister Roy Thomson, at the tender age of fourteen months. Little Worthie was an exceptionally bright child, and would make friends with all who showed her any attention. She was the joy and comfort of her parents. After a few brief days of sickness, in which she was attended by the skilled hands of her parents, who are both graduate nurses, and whose efforts to overcome the dread disease were directed by Drs. Richards, they were compelled to yield up their treasure, and bow their heads in submission to the Divine will. We laid her to rest in the beautiful cemetery at Gore Hill, till that glad day when the Life-giver shall restore her again to the mother's arms that were permitted to embrace her treasure for a few brief months ere it was laid aside from the time of trouble so soon to come upon all the earth. Pastor C. H. Watson, who officiated at the grave, spoke words of comfort to the sorrowing parents in the presence of a large gathering of sympathizers. By a happy coincidence, we sang at the close of the service the beautiful hymn, "When He cometh to make up His jewels," the very hymn the mother always sang in lulling her babe to sleep. That God will abundantly bless the parents, and enable them to learn the precious lessons that will ensure to them a glad reunion when Jesus comes is the earnest prayer of the writer.

W. G. BRITTAIN.

Australasian Record

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OF SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTISTS

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WHEN your copy of the RECORD comes in a red wrapper, it indicates that your subscription is expiring, and that your renewal is kindly solicited. Please order promptly, that no copies may be missed.

APPROVED advertisements will be published in the RECORD at a charge of 2s. 6d., forty words or less, for each insertion, and 1d. per word for each additional word. Remittance must always accompany copy for advertisements.

BROTHER FISHER has returned from Western Australia and brings a good report of the health food work, not only in the West, but in other parts of the field.

IT is expected that Pastor Fulton and Pastor Snow and family will arrive in Sydney from America about December 28. A Union Conference council has been called for December 31, at Warburton, Victoria.

THROUGH a mistake a number of our subscribers received their paper of November 29 in a red wrapper who should not have been thus notified. Those who received only the one red wrapper may know that they are among those who received a false alarm.

FROM correspondence received from Pastor Fulton we learn that during the early part of the General Conference council in California, it was decided to organize the Eastern Division of the General Conference, and that the name chosen for this organization is the "General Conference Division of the Far East."

BROTHER W. O. JOHANSON is connecting with the Union Conference office to assist in the treasurer's department. Brother Johanson has been carrying responsibilities for some time in the business office of the Signs Company at Warburton, and we are glad to welcome him to the Union office.

WE have come up to the time of the election of church officers. The importance of this work can hardly be overestimated; for the growth and spiritual life of the church, and its prosperity in every phase and department, are dependent to a very large extent on the selection of proper officers.

OF the one thousand copies of the first edition of the Morning Watch Calendar ordered by New South Wales on December 9, nearly nine hundred copies have been sold, and more orders are coming in every day. These are for our own people and do not include those to be sold to the public from the second edition of which nearly four hundred and fifty had already been sent out.

"£1,000 to foreign missions is their *reducible* minimum." This should be, "£1,000 to foreign missions is the *irreducible* minimum." If all having the paper, and especially those who are likely to take part in this service, will make the correction in their copy of the January *Leader* ("The Australasian Young People's Goal for 1916," page 19), it will set the matter right.

WE are receiving many favourable comments on the Morning Watch Calendar for next year. All who see it are pleased with its appearance and contents, and the orders are coming in rapidly. We hope none of our young people will fail to order before the New Year. The second edition to be sold to the public is also going well, and we trust that by January 1 all will have been sold.

AMONG those in attendance at the General Conference council held in November at Loma Linda, California, were Pastors Conradi and Guy Dail from Europe and Pastor Fitzgerald from Great Britain. These brethren representing the war-affected countries gave most encouraging reports of the growth of the work. During the eighteen months ending June 30, 1915, 8,092 had been taken into church membership in the European Division.

SISTER HILL, in writing from Moorea, Society Islands, sends the following cheering news: "Our hearts have been encouraged by seeing seven take their stand for the truth in Vaiari where we have been holding meetings, and there are three others considering this step. The Lord has indeed blessed our efforts. We have some good Sabbath meetings with these believers, and we have commenced a young people's meeting on Sabbath afternoon. This is well attended, as some from the outside like to come and take part. These young people set an example to the white youth, in the willing way in which they take part in the meetings. They are also learning their Bible Study texts, and thus far can repeat them correctly, and are looking forward to the end of the quarter, hoping that they may obtain a certificate. I believe the young people's meetings will do much to keep them together."

SISTER WICKS, in writing from Aitutaki, Cook Islands, refers to an interesting incident, that shows how the truth is finding its way into other islands of the group. She says: "When the last steamer came from the northern islands, a man from Palmerston Island came ashore and talked with some of our people. He told them that he had started to keep the Sabbath, though he still kept Sunday, as the law of the land required it; but God had told him to keep the Sabbath. My husband heard of this and went to see him just as he was going aboard the steamer, and invited him to our home when the ship comes back. He promised that he would come. We are making up a packet of tracts for him, and also some to give away on Palmerston. We believe his knowledge of the truth has been obtained from the *Tuatua Mou*."

A SUBSCRIBER for *Life and Health* writes to the North New Zealand Tract Society: "I am well pleased with the magazine. After reading it, I post it away to my friends in Ireland, and they are delighted with it. I wish that I could tell you of the vast amount of good these magazines are doing in the homes they reach. I wish you to renew my subscription for the next twelve months; and also to send me the cookery book and the "World's Crisis." Later this person wrote: "I have received your very kind letter and the two books. The "World's Crisis" I have not read yet, but expect to do so this week. The cookery book I like very much, and will ask you to send me four or five more, that I may send them to friends in Ireland. It is a splendid little book and should be in every home. I am delighted with *Life and Health*."